PULSAR

Sizing the US → Kyrgyzstan corridor

Converting an informal remittance flow onto legal stablecoin rails — starting with Chicago

Alliance interview prep · 10 June 2026

The wedge: a fast-growing, underserved corridor

Recorded US→KG flow already tops $100M and is growing fast — and the diaspora moves more still through informal channels.

>$100M

Recorded US→KG transfers, 2025 (NBKR)

Growing fast — $12.2M in December alone (~$146M run-rate)

~$150M

Bottom-up diaspora estimate, incl. informal

Corroborates the official trend; OTC / hawala on top

~6.4%

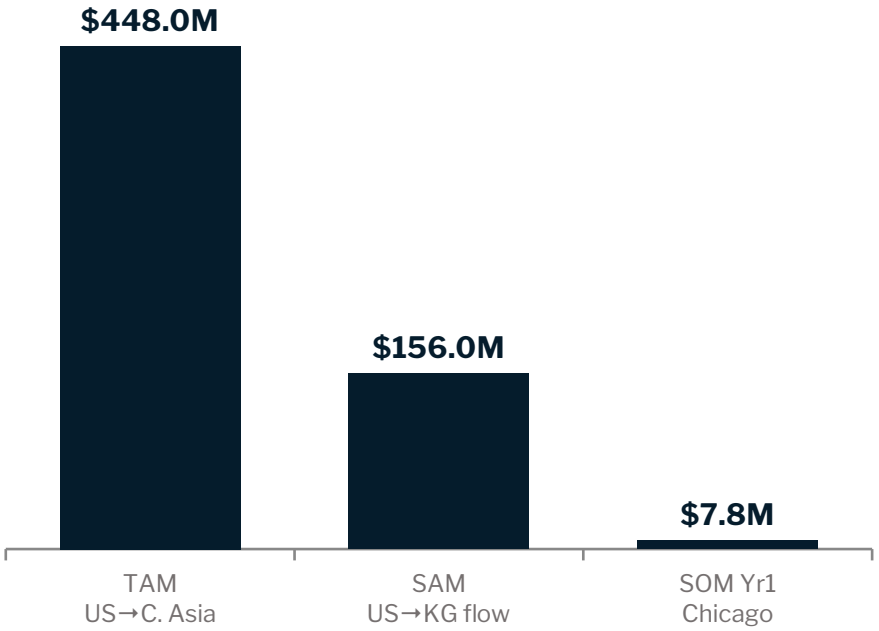
World Bank global avg cost to send $200

Q3 2025 — vs our 1.5% all-in. WU = fee + 1–3% FX, not flat

Why this is the opportunity: the formal US→KG corridor is already growing double-digits with no one serving it well, and migrants accept the friction of informal transfers because the alternative is too expensive or excludes them. We remove the friction, keep them legal, and capture a corridor in motion.

TAM → SAM → SOM

Bottom-up, US →Central Asia diaspora. Take rate 1.5%.



Layer	Population	GMV/yr	Rev @1.5%
TAM — US→C. Asia	~115,000	~$448M	~$6.7M
SAM — US→KG	~40,000	~$156M	~$2.3M
SOM — Chicago Yr1	~6,500 senders	~$7.8M	~$117k

Expansion: KZ (VASP licence applies) → TJ / UZB → EU diaspora.

We exclude Russia (~89% of KG inflows + the sanctions-risk source). Total KG market ~$3.5B is reference only; our addressable pool is the non-Russia flow — ~$300–385M/yr, growing as Russia's share falls.

Beachhead: Chicago

#1 Kyrgyz hub in the US — General Consulate opened downtown 2022.

~10,000 settled Kyrgyz in Chicago metro (Chicago Council, 2023); up to ~40k in the consular district

65% estimated remitting → ~6,500 active senders

$6,000 avg sent / sender / yr ($500 a month — conservative for US wages)

~$39M Chicago Kyrgyz flow / yr · ~$580k revenue ceiling at 1.5%

Where they are

Northern suburbs

Mount Prospect · Des Plaines · Schaumburg · Elk Grove Village · Norridge

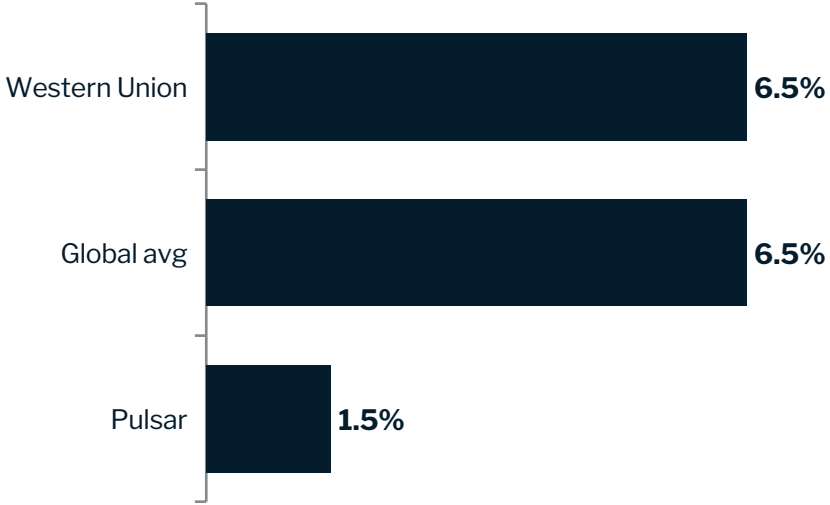
Community anchors

Kyrgyz Community Center (Arlington Heights) · General Consulate (downtown, 2022) · diaspora TG / WhatsApp groups

Unit economics

Cheaper than incumbents; community distribution drives a low CAC.

Cost to send $200



$90

revenue / active user / yr

$190

LTV (3-yr life, 70% margin)

13×

LTV / CAC at $15 community CAC

5×

LTV / CAC even at $40 paid CAC

How we reach Chicago

Tight, high-trust diaspora = distribution through community, not paid ads.

1. **Digital where demand lives** Join the diaspora Telegram / WhatsApp groups where informal transfers already happen — meet users in the warm channel.

2. **Community anchors** Kyrgyz Community Center, mosques, consular events — physical trust points.

3. **Retail partners** Central Asian grocery stores, restaurants, halal markets as on-ramps.

4. **Referral loop** First transfer free / fee credit — cheap and viral in a high-trust network.

5. **Target the switchers** People already paying WU's fee + FX margin (often >5% all-in on small sends) or running risky OTC cash.

From wedge to venture scale

Win a narrow corridor first; the prize is the regional flow and B2B settlement.

WEDGE

US→KG consumer

Win Chicago. ~$156M corridor flow (high case).

EXPAND

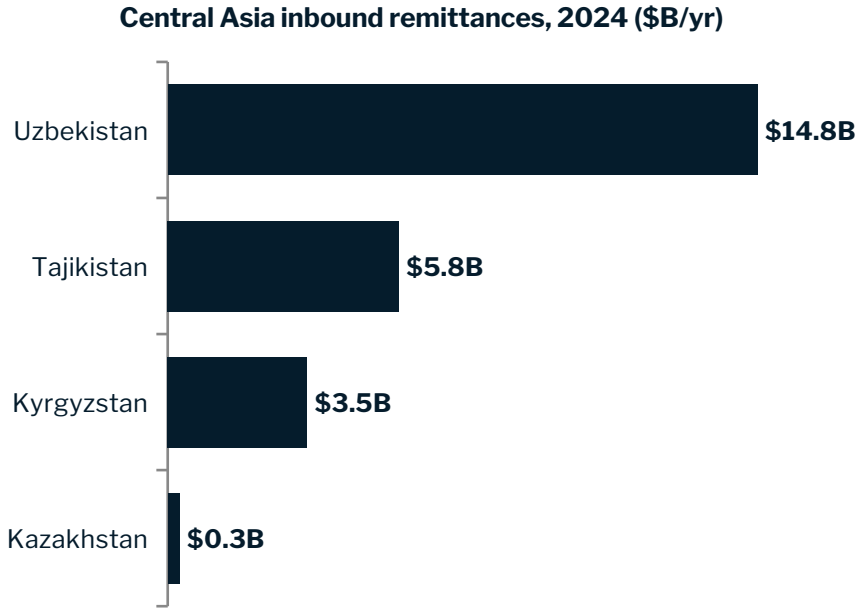
US / EU → Central Asia

Kazakhstan first — Dias's VASP licence applies. Then Uzbekistan, Tajikistan.

PLATFORM

B2B stablecoin settlement

Settle bank / MTO flows on stablecoin rails. Phase 3.



Expansion: the same diaspora, three more markets

Win US→KG, then run the same rails where Central Asians already work — Korea, Europe, and the Gulf.

$534M

Korea → Uzbekistan remittances, 2024

+56% YoY · ~95–100k Uzbek workers · ~$8M rev at 1.5%

~27,800

Central Asians on UK seasonal visas, 2024

78% of all 35,600 visas; EU work permits tripled to ~79k

1M

UAE migrant-worker cap (up from 15k)

Gulf→CA flow not yet booked — optionality, not a sized market

The proof corridor: Korea→Kyrgyzstan remittances fell from $45.5M (2024) to $1.8M (2025) — not lost demand, but a correspondent bank pulling USD SWIFT for Kyrgyz banks. The senders are still there; the rail broke. Stablecoin settlement is not hostage to one bank's correspondent relationship — that is exactly the failure we route around.

Outbound: KG's digital economy must pay the world

Not only inbound. Kyrgyz firms earning and paying across borders are the B2B wedge — the same broken rails, the opposite direction.

$187M

High-Tech Park IT-service exports, 2025

+53% YoY (from $122M) · 95% of HTP revenue

463

High-Tech Park resident firms

70 countries · ~3,000 tech jobs · $196M revenue

~40%

of HTP exports go to the US (>$50M)

The US ↔ KG digital corridor already runs both ways

The outbound mirror: these firms collect from 70 countries and pay developers and contractors abroad — over the same correspondent-banking rails that just collapsed the Korea→KG corridor. KG's Web3 community is already publicly asking for exactly this. We haven't sized the contractor-payment line precisely, so we frame outbound as demonstrated, on-thesis demand — not a headline TAM.

The B2B prize: from corridor to settlement rails

The consumer corridors earn the licences and bank relationships. B2B settlement is where it becomes infrastructure.

$226B

B2B stablecoin payments, 2025

+733% YoY — the fastest-growing slice of stablecoin volume

60×

B2B run-rate growth in 30 months

<$100M/mo (early 2023) to >$6B/mo (mid-2025)

66%

of stablecoin supply sits in emerging markets

A hedge against FX & correspondent-bank instability — our region's condition

Why we win B2B: the buyer needs regulatory access + distribution + technical rails at once. Our VASP licence, NatBank relationship, PSP path to legal KG bank APIs and direct bank conversations are the moat a pure-software competitor can't copy. Regional anchor: ~$25B Central Asia inflows (2024); a thin take on the non-Russia, Western-corridor slice compounds with corridor count, not headcount.

Assumptions & honesty check

Load-bearing assumptions to pressure-test

- $500/month average send and 65% sender rate are reasoned estimates, not measured — have $300 (low) and $800 (US-wage) brackets ready.
- Population: avoid stating 100k Chicago / 200k US in the room — sourced figures are ~10k settled (40k consular district) and 30–50k US. Census undercounts recent/undocumented arrivals, so frame the upside as “officially undercounted.”
- World Bank shows no transparent provider records for the US→KG corridor — itself evidence of how underserved it is.